GinCol Lab · Aula

Student worksheet

Contemporary World History · 1st year of Bachillerato · The historian's craft · Class 5 of 6 · With Tristán

Were workers better off? Two accounts

Class video: https://youtu.be/-me-Vr6sIuo

The code leads to the video.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Before you start: your bet

Compare two generations of British men: those born around 1820 and those born around 1850. The real wage of their childhood years rose by 18%. **What happened to their height?** Mark one and explain why.

1. It rose.

2. It didn't change.

3. It fell.

At the end of the class. What do the data say? What does that answer depend on?

While you watch the video

1. What does Ure write about the children in the factories? And Engels about a working-class district of Manchester?

2. Which of Ure's words are missing from Engels' translation? Why does it matter?

3. Compare the two titles: in what three ways do they differ?

4. The same line gives –3% or +67%. Why? What do historians do to avoid that?

5. Why can't you say that Manchester workers lived to 17?

6. What are the three questions you put to a piece of data?

What each one measures

Fill in the table with what you hear in the video.

Measure	What happens	Where the data come from	One drawback
Real wage			
Height			
Working hours			
Average age at death			

Measure	What happens	Where the data come from	One drawback
Life expectancy			

Fact, interpretation or value judgement?

Mark **F**, **I** or **V** and say how it would be argued.

1. In 1841, life expectancy at birth in England and Wales was about 40 years for boys and 42 for girls.

2. Wages rose little because profits were reinvested in machines.

3. A richer country is a better country.

4. Cotton handloom weavers went from about 240,000 in 1820 to about 10,000 in 1860.

5. The Industrial Revolution was a catastrophe.

Your argument, in four pieces

Write an argument for or against this sentence: **«In the long run, industrialisation improved the lives of the majority»**.

- **Claim:**

- **Evidence:**

- **Reasoning:**

- **Objection** (the best one you can think of):

- **Your claim, again**, after the objection: how far does it go?

Keep thinking

You hear this sentence: «With artificial intelligence, it'll be like in the Industrial Revolution: first, layoffs; then, new trades». Ask it the three questions. Which years? What is it measuring? For whom?

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